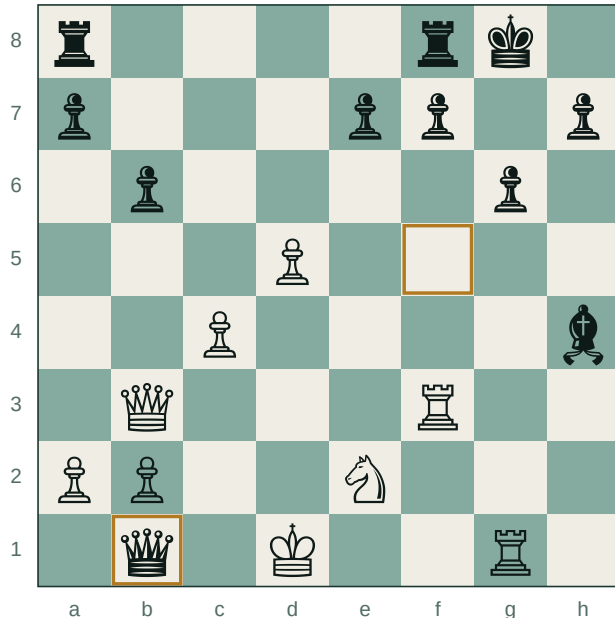


Interference tactics: White, move 35

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 34...Qb1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Kd2 Qe4 36. Rf4 Qe5 37. Rxh4

35.Kd2 The king moves from d1 to d2. The changed line means the rook on g1 attacks the queen on b1. Recorded reply: **35...Qe4**.

36.Rf4 The rook moves from f3 to f4. From f4 it attacks queen on e4 and bishop on h4. Recorded reply: **36...Qe5**.

37.Rxh4 The rook captures the bishop on h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.